

RHYTHM CHANGES 303

FROM DIGGING DEEPER VIDEO #88

Once we can play diatonically over Rhythm Changes (Digging Deeper #82), and once we can nail the chord changes (Digging Deeper #85), the world opens up for us. We understand melody (#82), and we understand harmony and getting inside the chords (#85). Now we can have some fun.

Joe Henderson was a master of playing both inside and outside, and one of his techniques for coming up with more interesting melodies was rooted in coming up with harmonic substitutions or reharmonizations to underlie those melodies. Substitute/different chord changes. Here, we'll look at an example of this, based on four measures from one of his solos.

"A" Section - first four measures (I - VI - ii - V - iii - VI - ii - V - I)

Original Rhythm Changes solo notation. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The melody is written on a single staff. Chords are indicated above the staff: Gmaj7, E7, Am7, D7, Bm7, E7, Am7, D7, G7. The melody consists of eighth and quarter notes, with a triplet of eighth notes in the first measure.

The notes he plays (above) look pretty questionable relative to the chord changes, until we see that he wasn't thinking about those chord changes at all. The chords below are what Joe Henderson was probably thinking. That said, the band, the rhythm section was still playing regular Rhythm Changes (I - VI - ii - V, etc).

"A" Section - first four measures (what Joe was probably thinking)

Reharmonized Rhythm Changes notation. The key signature is one sharp (F#). The melody is written on a single staff. Chords are indicated above the staff: Gmaj7, Bb7, A7, Ab7, G7, F7, Eb7, D7, G7. The melody is identical to the original. Brackets below the staff indicate harmonic substitutions: 'Tritone Sub' under the first two measures (Gmaj7/Bb7 and A7/Ab7) and 'Descending Bass Line' under the next three measures (G7/F7, Eb7/D7, and G7).